

Google IO 2026

Sundar Pichai gave numbers to explain rapid AI adoption

—By Jayesh Shinde

At Google IO 2026's opening keynote, Sundar Pichai's calm demeanour was in direct contrast to all the gargantuan numbers he was dropping to underscore just how fast the whole world was adopting AI.

One after another, the Google CEO belted out a sequence of stats that paints a vivid picture of AI adoption moving at a velocity that's hard to grasp in any single frame. How AI is being used by average users, developers, and all the cool products being made.

Pichai also spoke about how AI is eating into Google's infrastructure capex, and how the company's pouring tens of billions into keeping the AI party going. Here are some broad strokes of some of the most humbling stats and figures Pichai spoke about during his Google IO 2026 keynote.

A quadrillion tokens a month
The cleanest illustration of the scale of AI being used came from Pichai's point on token volume – the fundamental unit of data that AI models process. "Two years, we were processing 9.7 trillion tokens a month across the surface,

that's a huge number," Pichai said. "Last year at IO, that grew to about 480 trillion tokens. And fast forward to today, that number has jumped seven times to 3.2 quadrillion tokens per month."

He acknowledged the absurdity of this moment, absolute bonkers in terms of the unit itself. "Never imagined I'd say



quadrillion in an IO keynote, but here we are," Pichai said with his smile.

On the developer side, the numbers are outsized. "Over 8.5 million of you are now building new apps and experiences with our models monthly. And our model APIs are now processing around 19 billion tokens per minute," Pichai said. "Over the past 12 months, over 375 customers each processed more than 1 trillion tokens, representing incredible demand for AI across the industry."

Billion-user products

"We now have 13 products with over a billion users each. Five of those have more than 3 billion users," Pichai noted, framing Gemini as the main reason this adoption curve hasn't flattened.

Google Search has seen its impact.

"AI Overviews now has over 2.5 billion monthly users. AI mode has been a revelation, our biggest upgrade to search ever," he said. "In just a year, it's surpassed 1 billion monthly users. When people use our AI-powered features in search, they use search more."

The Gemini app itself has more than doubled in a year.

"Last year at IO, the Gemini app had 400 million monthly active users. Today, we have surpassed 900 million, more than doubling in a year. In that same time, daily requests have grown over seven times."

One category – image generation – will make you sit up straight in your seat, if it doesn't drop your jaw. "More than 50 billion images have been generated with Nano Banana models," Pichai said. "It was a breakout star this past year."

tinyurl.com/7cwhsd90

CTRL + LOL

Your monthly dose of tech humour | Vol.13

